



RCCG OCEANIA

Family & Parenting

GOD'S DESIGN FOR MARRIAGE AND FAMILY

AT A GLANCE

BIG IDEA

Marriage and family are not just social constructs but divine institutions established by God. Understanding the roles and responsibilities within these relationships is crucial for personal and societal success. By choosing the right partner and investing in the relationship, individuals can fulfill God's purpose for their lives.

PRIMARY PASSAGES

Ephesians 5

1 Corinthians 7

Ephesians 2

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Marriage and family are central to God's plan for the earth.
- The first institution God established was the family.
- Relationships significantly impact a person's life and success.
- Choosing the right partner is essential for a fulfilling marriage.
- Intentional love and learning are key to a successful marriage.

INTRODUCTION

Marriage and family are foundational elements in God's design for humanity. These institutions are not merely societal constructs but are divinely ordained to reflect God's love and purpose. Understanding the roles within these relationships is essential for personal fulfillment and societal stability.

SCRIPTURE READING

Ephesians 5 — This passage highlights the sacrificial love husbands should have for their wives, mirroring Christ's love for the church.

1 Corinthians 7 — Emphasizes the importance of focusing on pleasing one's partner in marriage.

Genesis 2 — Describes the creation of the first family, emphasizing the importance of companionship and unity.

KEY POINTS

1. **FOUNDATIONAL ROLE OF FAMILY** — God established the family as the first institution, highlighting its importance in His plan for humanity. Families are meant to disciple and influence the world. The family unit serves as the primary context for nurturing faith and values, reflecting God's love and order. Adam and Eve were the first family, setting a precedent for all human relationships.

- Reflect on the role of your family in your spiritual life.
- Consider ways to strengthen family bonds through shared faith practices.
- Discuss with family members how you can collectively serve your community.

Scripture: [Genesis 2:24](#) [Deuteronomy 6:6-7](#)

2. **IMPACT OF RELATIONSHIPS** — Relationships are the most impactful aspect of a person's life. They shape personal growth and success, making it crucial to choose partners wisely. The Bible emphasizes the importance of companionship and mutual support. Relationships can either propel individuals towards their God-given purpose or distract them from it.

- Evaluate the influence of your closest relationships on your spiritual journey.
- Seek counsel from trusted mentors about your relationship choices.
- Pray for wisdom in forming and maintaining healthy relationships.

Scripture: [Proverbs 13:20](#) [Ecclesiastes 4:9-10](#)

3. **CHOOSING THE RIGHT PARTNER** — Entering a relationship for the wrong reasons often leads to choosing the wrong partner. It's vital to focus on being the right person first. The Bible encourages believers to seek partners who share their faith and values. A strong foundation in God is essential for a lasting and fulfilling marriage.

- Reflect on your motivations for seeking a relationship.
- Identify qualities in yourself that you can develop to be a better partner.
- Pray for guidance in choosing a partner who aligns with your faith.

Scripture: [2 Corinthians 6:14](#) [1 Peter 3:7](#)

KEY POINTS (CONT.)

4. **INTENTIONAL LOVE AND LEARNING** — Successful marriages require intentional love and continuous learning. Investing in understanding marriage is as important as career development. The Bible teaches that love is patient and kind, requiring effort and dedication. Couples are encouraged to grow together in faith and understanding.

- Commit to regular times of prayer and study with your partner.
- Attend workshops or read books on marriage enrichment.
- Practice active listening and empathy in your daily interactions.

Scripture: Ephesians 5 1 Corinthians 7

GROUP DISCUSSION

Tip: Use these questions to guide the group from seeing → understanding → applying.

OBSERVATION

- What does the Bible say about the role of family in God's plan?
- How does Ephesians 5 describe the relationship between husbands and wives?
- What are some key responsibilities mentioned in 1 Corinthians 7 for married couples?

INTERPRETATION

- Why do you think God established the family as the first institution?
- How can relationships impact a person's spiritual growth?
- What does it mean to choose the right partner according to biblical principles?

APPLICATION

- In what ways can you strengthen your family relationships to reflect God's design?
- How can you ensure that your relationships are aligned with your faith?
- What steps can you take to be more intentional in your love and learning within marriage?

PRAYER FOCUS

Pray for wisdom in understanding and fulfilling God's design for marriage and family.

Ask for guidance in choosing and nurturing relationships that align with biblical principles.

Seek strength and patience to practice intentional love within family and marriage.

NEXT STEP

Reflect on your family and relationships, seeking ways to align them more closely with God's design and purpose.

CONCLUSION

Understanding God's design for marriage and family is essential for personal and societal well-being. By aligning our relationships with biblical principles, we can experience the fullness of God's purpose for our lives. Let us commit to nurturing our families and relationships with intentional love and faithfulness.